AntiFake glossary

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Throughout this toolkit, we have used words that help us understand how disinformation and discriminatory narratives are constructed, circulate and can be analysed.

This glossary does not replace the explanations in earlier chapters. It is a quick reference tool for returning to a concept whenever we need it.

False or misleading rumour

False or misleading information that circulates as if it were true. It can be a news story, photograph, video, piece of data, screenshot, audio recording or social media post.

A false rumour can also mix true and false information or use real content out of context.

Disinformation

False, manipulated or misleading information that can alter how we understand a situation.

It can work by inventing information, but also by manipulating data, images or contexts, selecting only some of the facts, or presenting information in a way that leads us to an incorrect conclusion.

Source

The origin of the information we are consulting.

It can be a person, document, institution, research study, database, media outlet or any other place from which information comes.

Knowing the source helps us check it.

Original source

The place where information initially comes from.

If a post says “according to a study”, the study is the original source we will try to find. If it refers to official data, we will look for the body that published it.

Reaching the original source allows us to check what it really said and in what context.

Verification

The process of checking information before accepting it as true.

It can involve finding the original source, checking the date, comparing different sources, consulting data or checking the origin of a photograph or video.

This is what we do when AntiFake says:

CHECK.

Context

The information we need to understand a fact, figure, phrase, photograph or video correctly.

The place, date, circumstances, what happened before or what we are comparing data with can completely change how we interpret information.

Stereotype

An oversimplified idea that attributes the same characteristics to everyone in a group.

Stereotypes reduce people who differ from one another to a single image and can feed prejudice and discriminatory narratives.

Prejudice

A prior judgement or idea about a person or group that shapes how we perceive or treat them.

Prejudices may relate to origin, skin colour, gender, religion, sexual orientation, economic situation and many other characteristics.

Discriminatory narrative

A way of explaining reality that presents particular people or groups as inferior, problematic, dangerous, less capable or less deserving of rights.

It can be constructed through repeated words, images, stereotypes, associations and information that reinforce a particular view of a group.

Hate speech

Communication that attacks or uses derogatory or discriminatory language against a person or group because of identity-related characteristics such as origin, racialisation, religion, gender or sexual orientation, among others.

The context, intention, content and possible consequences of a message are important when analysing it.

Racism

A system of ideas, practices and inequalities that discriminates against, excludes or disadvantages people on grounds such as origin, skin colour or racialisation.

Racism can appear in individual behaviours, but also in speech, rules, institutions and social structures.

Racialisation

The process through which a society attributes meanings, stereotypes or characteristics to people or groups on the basis of features such as skin colour, origin, culture or religion, and treats them according to these categories.

Xenophobia

Rejection, hostility or prejudice towards people perceived as foreign or as coming from other countries or cultures.

Islamophobia

Prejudice, hostility, discrimination or hatred against Muslim people or people perceived as Muslim.

LGTBI-phobia

Rejection, discrimination, hostility or violence against lesbian, gay, bisexual, trans, intersex or other people because of their sexual orientation, gender identity or gender expression.

Antigypsyism

A specific form of racism, discrimination and prejudice directed against Roma people.

Ableism

Discrimination and inequality affecting disabled people, based on treating particular physical, sensory, intellectual or mental abilities as the norm.

Intersectionality

A perspective that helps us understand how different inequalities and forms of discrimination can intersect in the life of the same person.

In AntiFake, it allows us to observe which forms of discrimination appear in a narrative, how they relate and how their intersection can reinforce discrimination or vulnerability among those affected.

Generalisation

Moving from an individual case to a claim about an entire group.

For example, using one person's behaviour to attribute the same characteristic to everyone of the same origin, religion, gender or social group.

Dehumanisation

The process of representing people or groups in a way that erases their individuality, dignity or status as people with rights.

It can occur when a group is discussed as a mass, a threat or a problem, rather than as people with diverse histories and realities.

Discrimination

Unequal or harmful treatment of a person or group linked to characteristics such as origin, racialisation, gender, religion, sexual orientation, disability or other personal or social circumstances.

Pending legal concepts

The glossary remains to be completed with legal concepts once the legal information sheets have been validated by Isabel Carmona.